UU-B-366a
December 27, 1962

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. UU-B-366
January 20, 1956
(See 6.5.)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, SECTIONAL-POST-TYPE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. Binders covered by this specification are of the sectional-post type, for general office use (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and classes.* The binders shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I.—Top-locking mechanism.
Type II.—End-locking mechanism.
Class 1.—Cloth hinges.
Class 2.—Metal hinges.

TABLE I.—*Dimensions (sizes)*

Sheet size [1]	Center-to-center of posts, plus or minus 1/32 inch	Diameter of posts, plus or minus 1/64 inch
Inches	*Inches*	*Inch*
8½ by 11	4¼	3/8
8½ by 14	4¼	3/8
9½ by 12	7	3/8
11 by 8½	7	3/8
11 by 14	7	3/8
11 by 17	7	3/8
12 by 9½	7	3/8
8½ by 14	6⅝	5/16
9¼ by 11⅞	7⅛	5/16
11 by 14	8¼	5/16

[1] The first dimension is the binding edge.

1.2.2 *Dimensions (sizes).* Unless otherwise specified, the binders shall be furnished in the dimensions listed in table I, under "Sheet size," as specified in the invitation for bids (see 3.2 and 6.2).

1.2.3 *Colors.* (See 3.4.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-B-623—Book Cover Board.
CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-576—Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.
PPP-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

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Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547—Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall be as specified hereinafter.

3.2 Construction and dimensions (sizes). The binders shall consist essentially of two covers held together by means of two sectional posts and a locking mechanism (see 3.7). The outside dimensions of the binders shall be sufficiently larger than the "Sheet size," indicated in table I, to protect filler sheets and index tabs contained in the binders.

3.3 Covers. Each cover shall be made from book cover board conforming to UU-B-623, and having an average thickness of not less than 0.220 inch and a minimum bursting strength of 800 points. Corners of covers at the index edge shall be rounded.

3.4 Binding materials. Covers and post housing shall be bound with a continuous piece of Army duck having two-ply yarns (two single yarns twisted together) in both the warp and the filling directions, or of latex fiber made from new cotton rag fibers impregnated with latex. The Army duck and latex fiber materials shall each weigh not less than 7 ounces per square yard, and shall be slate-gray, slate-blue, green, or brown in color, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2). The binding material shall be carried over the post housing and over the inside face of covers at least 5/8 inch beyond the edges. The binding material shall be securely glued in place.

3.4.1 *Army duck.*

3.4.1.1 *Colorfastness to crocking* shall have a rating of at least "fair" when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.4.1.2 *Breaking strength.* The Army duck shall have a breaking strength of 100 pounds warp and 60 pounds filling with a minus tolerance of 5 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.4.2 *Latex fiber.*

3.4.2.1 *Colorfastness.* The latex fiber shall not show any appreciable change in color when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2.1.

3.4.2.2 *Tearing and breaking strength.* The latex fiber shall not tear or break in either a wet or dry condition when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2.2.

3.4.2.3 *Flexure.* The latex fiber shall show no undue wear when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2.3.

3.4.2.4 *Moisture.* The latex fiber shall

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not tear or show other adverse effects when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2.4.

3.4.2.5 *Abrasion.* The latex fiber shall not show any evidence of excessive wear when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2.5.

3.5 Lining. Lining for the inside face of covers shall be a suitable paper having a minimum weight of 60 pounds per 500 sheets, 24 by 36 inches, sheet size, securely glued to the cover.

3.6 Hinge. The hinge shall connect the binding post housing to the cover.

3.6.1 *Class* 1. Class 1 hinges shall consist of three thicknesses of binding material securely glued together.

3.6.2 *Class* 2. Class 2 hinges shall be of the continuous piano type made of cold-rolled steel.

3.7 Post assembly. The post assembly shall consist of a metal housing hinged to each cover. The lower housing shall be fitted with threaded base sockets into which post sections shall be screwed. The upper housing shall hold the locking mechanism.

3.7.1 *Housings.* The lower housing shall be a continuous metal tube or a continuous flat metal plate. If of the tube type, the lower housing shall be made of steel not less than 0.035 inch thick. The ends of housing tubes shall be capped with aluminum, steel, plastic, or rubber end plugs. If of the plate type, the lower housing shall be of steel having a cross section of not less than 0.0625 inch by 0.875 inch or 16-gage strip steel. The plate shall be backed by two sheets of not less than 0.120-inch-thick book cover board, securely glued together and to the housing plate. The upper housing shall be a continuous metal tube similar to the lower housing, fitted with either a top-locking mechanism as specified in 3.7.1.1 or an end-locking mechanism as specified in 3.7.1.2, capable of holding the housing firmly at any desired position on the posts. Locking mechanisms shall operate smoothly and efficiently.

3.7.1.1 *Type I binders.* The top-locking mechanism for type I binders shall be operated by either a knurled thumb knob or slide button on top of the housing.

3.7.1.2 *Type II binders.* The end-locking mechanism for type II binders shall be located at one end of the housing and shall be operated by means of a winged clock key (see 3.7.1.2.1). The locking device shall be constructed of cold-rolled steel. All surfaces of the locking device shall be casehardened.

3.7.1.2.1 *Key.* One winged clock key shall be furnished with each type II binder and secured to binder for safekeeping in shipment in accordance with standard commercial practice. (See 5.1.)

3.7.2 *Posts.* Unless otherwise specified, the center-to-center location and the diameter of the posts shall be as shown in table I and as specified in the invitation for bids. Posts shall be made up of sections assembled by means of male and female threads. Posts shall be made of steel having a hardness of not less than 65 on the Rockwell B scale. Unless otherwise specified, each post equipment furnished with binders shall consist of two 1/2-inch sections, one 1-inch section, and one 1/2-inch smooth top section. Posts shall be placed equidistant from edges of binder within 1/8-inch tolerance.

3.8 Finish. Unless otherwise specified, all exposed metal parts shall be zinc-coated or shall be given a black oxide finish covered overall with a suitable drying oil or shall be otherwise treated to resist corrosion.

3.9 Index-tab allowance. Binders shall have an index-tab allowance of 7/8 inch, plus or minus 1/16 inch.

3.10 Marking. Unless otherwise specified, the following information shall be legibly printed or stamped on the inside of one cover of each binder:

Manufacturer's name or trademark
"Property U. S. Government"

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3.11 Workmanship. Binders shall be finished in a neat and workmanlike manner. All edges and surfaces shall be smooth and securely fastened. Binders shall be free from defects which affect the appearance and any defects and imperfections which might impair the serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **Inspection responsibility.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 *Component and material inspection.* In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, inspected, and tested in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification. In the event of conflict, this specification will govern.

4.2 Sampling for acceptance.

4.2.1 *Inspection lot.* All binders of the same type, class, size, and color offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of inspection.

4.2.2 *Sampling for examination.* A random sample of binders shall be selected from each lot offered to the Government in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at level II. The Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent defective.

4.2.3 *Sampling for test.* Unless otherwise specified, random samples of materials used in the manufacture of binders shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level S. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Tests shall be conducted as specified in 4.4. The sample unit shall be that specified by the material specification where applicable, or as required for performance of tests. The lot size for determining the number of sample units shall be the number of shipping containers in each delivery of materials to the contractor.

TABLE II.—*Examination of end item*

Examine	Defects
Binders:	
Major:	Construction not as specified or defined.
	Dimensions (sizes) of binders, dimensions of posts, post separation, covers, and component parts not as specified.
	Mechanism, as applicable, does not operate smoothly and efficiently.
	Seams uneven; rough surfaces; poor adhesion; dirty, torn materials.
Minor:	Color not as specified.
Workmanship:	
Major:	Defects which affect the serviceability; not as specified.
Minor:	Defects which affect the appearance.
Identification marking:	
Minor:	Not as specified.

4.3 **Examination.** Each of the sample binders taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined to verify compliance with this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in table II. Any binder in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective binders in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

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4.4 Test procedures. Each sample of material taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be subjected to the tests specified below. Failure of the test sample in any of the tests specified in 4.4.1 through 4.4.1.2.5 shall constitute grounds for disqualification of material.

4.4.1 *Materials.*

4.4.1.1 *Army duck.* Army duck shall be tested for colorfastness to crocking and for breaking strength in accordance with CCC-T-191, methods 5660 and 5100, respectively.

4.4.1.2 *Latex fiber.*

4.4.1.2.1 *Colorfastness.* The latex fiber shall be wet thoroughly with water and then completely dried. After drying, the test sample shall be inspected for any appreciable change in color.

4.4.1.2.2 *Tearing or breaking strength.* The latex fiber shall not tear or break when subjected to a breaking force of approximately 25 pounds. The sample shall be tested in both a wet and a dry condition.

4.4.1.2.3 *Flexure.* The latex fiber sample shall be flexed 8,000 to 10,000 times without failure. The sample shall be flexed through a minimum bend radius of 135 degrees.

4.4.1.2.4 *Moisture.* The latex fiber sample shall be thoroughly soaked in water and subjected to the test specified in 4.4.1.2.2.

4.4.1.2.5 *Abrasion.* The latex fiber sample shall be subjected to continuous cycles of abrasion for approximately 5 minutes. The abrasive material shall be a medium grade of sandpaper.

4.4.1.3 *Book cover board.* Book cover board shall be tested, as applicable, in accordance with UU-B-623.

4.4.1.4 *Metal parts.* All exposed metal parts shall be tested for corrosion resistance by placing them in a boiling 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride for a period of 15 minutes. Upon being removed from this solution, metal parts shall be immediately immersed in 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride at room temperature. They shall then be removed from this solution, without having the adhering liquid wiped off, and allowed to dry for 24 hours at room temperature. The metal parts shall then be rinsed in lukewarm water, allowed to dry, and examined for evidence of corrosion.

4.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. The lot of packed and marked binders shall be examined for compliance with the applicable requirements of this specification. The lot size shall be the number of containers in each delivery. Examination of defects shall be as listed in table III. The number of shipping containers taken for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level L-8. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE III.—*Examination of preparation for delivery*

Examine	Defects
Shipping container.	Not type, class, or grade required.
Container closure.	Not as required by box specification.
Strapping.	Not type ordered; missing; incorrectly applied.
Case liners.	Missing; not barrier material required.
Weight.	Weight exceeds box design.
Marking for shipment.	Missing, illegible, incomplete, or erroneous.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

The definitions and applications of the levels of packing protection specified hereinafter shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102, for civil agencies only.

5.1 Packaging. Unless otherwise specified, type I binders, and type II with key, shall be packaged in paperboard boxes in accordance with standard commercial practice.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Binders, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in over-seas-type containers, conforming to PPP-B-576, PPP-B-591, PPP-B-601, PPP-B-621, or PPP-B-636, class 2. Gross weight of wood and wood-type containers shall not exceed 200 pounds. Gross weight of fiberboard containers shall not exceed the weight limitations of the applicable box specification. Shipping containers shall be provided with a sealed, waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547 and sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Binders, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in fiberboard boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class 1. Gross weight of fiberboard boxes shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Unless otherwise specified, binders, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carriers and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Fed. Std. No. 123, including specification classification (type, class, size, color, etc.).

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, unit packages, intermediate packages, and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The binders covered by this specification are intended for general office use and are commercially known as accounting binders.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein (see 3.7.2, 3.8, 3.10, 4.2.3, 5.1, and 5.2.3) and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Type, class, and dimensions (size) of binder required (see 1.2.1 and 1.2.2).

(c) Center-to-center dimensions and diameter of posts if other than those shown in table I (see 1.2.2).

(d) Color of binding material (see 1.2.3).

(e) Inspection responsibility (for civil agencies only) if other than as specified herein; and administrative provisions for inspection records, when applicable (see 4.1).

(f) Level of packing and any special marking required (see 5.2 and 5.3).

6.3 Transportation data. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Binders, loose-leaf, cloth, other than paper or pulpboard.

Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Binders, loose-leaf, cloth.

Truckload minimum weight (W) 30.4 pounds, (W) subject to Rule 34, National Freight Classification.

6.4 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no sample binders will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any

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particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.5 Supersession data. This specification includes the requirements of Military Specification MIL-B-4423 (USAF), dated 7 December 1951.

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MILITARY INTEREST:

Army—Q
Navy—S
Air Force—MOA

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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